Passepartout, on waking and looking out, could not believe that he was actually crossing India in a railway train. The **locomotive**, guided by an English engineer and fed with coal, threw out its smoke upon cotton, coffee, nutmeg, clove, and pepper plantations, while the steam curled in spirals around groups of palm-trees, in the midst of which were seen attractive bungalows, viharas (sort of abandoned monasteries), and marvellous temples decorated by the rich work of Indian architecture. Then they came upon vast areas extending to the **horizon**, with jungles where snakes and tigers lived. These creatures fled at the noise of the train. Then they came to forests where elephants stood **gazing** with sad eyes at the train as it passed.

At half-past twelve the train stopped at Burhampoor. The travellers made a **hasty** breakfast and started off for Assurghur. Now they travelled along the banks of the small river Tapty, which empties into the Gulf of Cambray, near Surat.

Then towards evening the train entered the valleys of the Sutpour Mountains, which separate the Khandesh from Bundelcund. It was three in the morning.

DO YOU KNOW?

Travelling improves memory and reduces the risk of heart diseases. It makes us more intelligent and happier. This has been proved by scientists.

Give a picturesque view through which the train travels.



GLOSSARY

proceeded	-	moved
fertile territory	-	rich vegetated area
locomotive	-	railway engine
horizon	-	the line at which the earth's surface and the sky appear to meet
gazing	-	look steadily
hasty	-	quick

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